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What does Tulu's new official language status mean?

How will the new status change the use of Tulu in administration? Is the Cabinet's decision enough?

Raviprasad Kamila

The story so far:

Karnataka government, in its Cabinet meeting held in Mangaluru on September 18, decided to accord the additional official (administrative) language status to Tulu, which is commonly spoken in Dakshina Kannada district, southern parts of Udupi district in Karnataka, and northern parts of Kasaragod district in Kerala. While making the announcement, Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said the status will apply to administrative matters in the two districts. The government will release ₹82 lakh annually for translation, training and language usage purposes.

How will the decision help people?

B. Shivarama Shetty, former Project Director, Centre of Excellence for Studies

in Classical Kannada, Central Institute of Indian Languages (CIIL), Mysuru, said that elected representatives can speak in Tulu at gram sabhas of gram panchayats, taluk panchayats, and zilla panchayats meetings. It also applies to urban local body meetings such as city corporation council, city municipal council and town municipal council meetings. The government circulars and orders issued in the two districts should also contain Tulu. People can submit applications to government departments in Tulu. This will make officials who do not know Tulu depend on translations, translators, or learn the basics of Tulu.

When did the government move to grant official status to Tulu begin?

When the BJP government was in power, the then Minister for Kannada and Culture, V. Sunil Kumar, on January 30, 2023, formed a committee headed by M.

Mohan Alva, Chairman, Alva's Education Foundation, Moodbidri, Dakshina Kannada, to study and submit a report on declaring Tulu as the second official language of Karnataka.

The committee was asked to submit its report to the government in a week. According to Mr. Kumar, the BJP government could not grant official language status to Tulu because the model code of conduct for the 2023 Assembly elections in Karnataka was declared on March 29, 2023, and the BJP lost power in the elections.

Later, the Congress government took over in Karnataka. It appointed a committee led by K. M. Gayatri, Director of Kannada and Culture, to study the procedures adopted by the Andhra Pradesh government to grant additional language status to Urdu.

This committee visited Andhra Pradesh on January 19 and 20, 2026 and studied

how Urdu is being used in administration. The committee submitted its report to the Karnataka government on March 4, against the backdrop of the move to declare Tulu as the additional official language.

Is the Cabinet's decision enough?

Article 345 of the Constitution allows each State legislature to choose one or more regional languages or Hindi as the official language for its official work. It says: "Subject to the provisions of articles 346 and 347, the Legislature of a State may by law adopt any one or more of the languages in use in the State or Hindi as the language or languages to be used for all or any of the official purposes of that State."

Section 2 of the Karnataka Official Language Act, 1963 states that Kannada is the official language.

Some law graduates say that if Karnataka is to implement the Cabinet's decision, it will have to amend the Karnataka Official Language Act to incorporate Tulu as an additional administrative language in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi districts. Once the amendment is approved by the appropriate authority, the Governor, the government will issue a notification, following which the Cabinet's decision will come into force. The governments of Andhra Pradesh and Telangana followed

the same procedure – amending their respective language laws – to declare Urdu as the second official language of their States.

How is this language introduced in academics?

Tulu is taught as the third optional language in schools, from Class 6 to Class 10, in Dakshina Kannada and Udupi districts. It was first introduced for Class 6 in the 2010-11 academic year. It is not being taught as a subject in pre-university and degree classes. Mangalore University introduced a two-year Tulu postgraduation programme in its erstwhile University Evening College (now closed down) in 2018-19. The programme was wound up from the academic year 2024-25, citing a lack of students in double digits who applied to join the programme.

Is it an independent language?

The Registrar General and Census Commissioner has recognised Tulu as an independent language of India ever since the department was established, and the Census Report gives statistics about Tulu speakers as a separate linguistic community.

It is treated as an important non-scheduled language of India. But it is not included in the Eighth Schedule of the Constitution.

Declaring Tulu as the additional official language Dakshina Kannada and Udupi districts Registrar general and census commissioner has recognised Tulu as an independent language of India.

Article 343 (the official language of the Union)

Article 346 (communication between states)

Article 345 of the Constitution of India empowers state legislatures to adopt any language in use in the state or Hindi for official purposes, subject to Articles 346 and 347. It also stipulates that English shall continue to be used for pre-existing official purposes until the state legislature provides otherwise by law.

Article 347 of the Constitution of India grants the President the discretionary power to officially recognize a language spoken by a substantial proportion of a state's population upon a formal demand. This provision allows the recognition to apply across the entire state or a specific part of it for designated administrative purposes.

Missing measure in India's magnet mission

Most Indians know the parable of several blind men trying to describe an elephant. One touches its trunk and believes it is a snake. Another feels its leg and insists it is a pillar. None is entirely wrong, yet none sees the whole animal.

India's strategy for advancing its cutting-edge technologies, aimed at becoming a global manufacturing leader, carries the risk of making a similar mistake. From EV motors and semiconductor fabrication facilities to precision manufacturing machineries, at the heart of each lies an unassuming component: the high-performance permanent magnet. They serve as the silent operating system of industrial acceleration.

Magnets are not all the same. Ferrite, Alnico and Samarium-Cobalt magnets continue to serve important industrial applications. Yet Neodymium-Iron-Boron (NdFeB) magnets have become the backbone of energy transition and advanced manufacturing because no other commercially available permanent magnet combines comparable magnetic strength with such a high power-to-weight ratio. Recognising its importance, India has begun strengthening its critical minerals and rare earth element strategy through initiatives such as the National Critical Mineral Mission, overseas mineral acquisitions, expanded geological exploration, and PLI schemes.

However, China's tight export controls on rare-earth magnets and materials in April 2025 not only revealed the

Suvajit Banerjee

Fellow at the National Council of Applied Economic Research (NCAER), New Delhi in the research vertical of Computable General Equilibrium Modelling and Policy Analysis. Views are personal

Sovini Mondal

Research Analyst at the NCAER in the research vertical of Computable General Equilibrium Modelling and Policy Analysis. Views are personal

Sanjib Pohit

Professor and Thematic Lead at the NCAER in the research vertical of Computable General Equilibrium Modelling and Policy Analysis. Views are personal

The strategic question is not simply whether India possesses rare-earth resources or whether imports from China can be reduced. The real policy challenge is understanding what happens in between

deep-seated vulnerabilities in global industrial value chains, but also the limits of our understanding. For India, the primary vulnerability does not stem from a shortage of critical minerals; rather, it lies in the absence of a comprehensive framework to pinpoint where strategic technological dependence is cultivated, accumulated and propagated throughout the permanent magnet value chain.

The journey of a magnet Consider a simple example. India's Annual Survey of Industries estimates the domestic permanent magnet market at around ₹750 crore. Yet international trade statistics indicate import values several times larger than that entire reported market. The gap may reflect differences in statistical coverage, industrial classification or supply-chain accounting. Whatever the explanation, policymakers face a troubling reality: they cannot confidently explain where all these magnets enter the economy or how they move through it. In other words, parts of India's permanent magnet economy appear to exist without being fully visible in statistics.

Unlike other products, permanent magnets pass through a long technological journey. Geological exploration leads to mining. Mining feeds mineral processing. Processing enables chemical separation. Separation produces oxides, which are refined into metals, transformed into alloys, engineered into magnetic materials, and finally manufactured into finished magnets. Each stage demands different scientific knowledge, industrial capability and technological maturity. This is why

discussions on critical minerals frequently miss the real point. The strategic question is not simply whether India possesses rare-earth resources or whether imports from China can be reduced. The real policy challenge is understanding what happens in between.

Although India has developed capabilities across several stages of permanent magnet manufacturing, the country still lacks a systematic way of identifying where those capabilities are globally competitive, where critical gaps persist, and how dependence accumulates across production stages. India's statistical system provides only a partial picture of what is mined, imported, manufactured,

One way to bridge this gap is through an Integrated Techno-Economic Mapping (ITEM) framework which presently is a missing piece in India's industrial policy toolkit. Such a framework brings together information on engineering and economic measurement to show how a permanent magnet is built, from minerals in the ground to the finished products that power advanced manufacturing. More importantly, it would identify where industrial capability should be built, where technological partnerships become essential, and where domestic investment would yield the greatest strategic return. A country may secure mineral resources yet remain dependent if it lacks processing and manufacturing capabilities.

Bridging this measurement gap is not an academic exercise; it is an industrial imperative.

India's permanent magnet economy

Geological exploration > Mining > Mineral processing > chemical separation > oxides > Metals > alloys > Magnetic materials > Magnets

High performance permanent magnet
Power to weight ratio
Neodymium-iron-Boron (NdFeB)

An Integrated Techno-Economic Mapping (ITEM) framework

Antidote to drugs

The government must tighten the monitoring of drug production

With the recent bust of a counterfeit medicine racket in Bengaluru, a public policy issue with broad ramifications for health care in the State has emerged. Centered around Bengaluru, relabelled or fake drugs, including cancer drugs, injections used in the ICU, were supplied to more than 90 hospitals and clinics across the State. The lid was blown off this elaborate scam after incidental raids, near Bidadi in Karnataka on August 18, found suspected fake drugs and expired drugs at a farmhouse which was an unlicensed unit. The consignment had a label value of ₹5 crore. Investigators said that the farmhouse was used in an illicit drug operation – involving the repacking of fake and expired drugs as fresh consignments, with altered expiry dates, and as expensive, imported branded drugs – which were then sold at massive discounts. The State later formed a Special Investigation Team to trace the wider network. While exploring the distribution mechanism, investigators found that the network had been supplying these drugs to over 90 hospitals in the State, in cahoots with a pharmacy in Bengaluru, indicating that a network was thriving well before the bust. A few persons have been arrested and the police are on the tail of another who is not in the country at present. The impunity with which the scammers were operating is an indication of the unreliable scrutiny of the quality of drugs in the market. The biggest concern, however, is patient safety, given that these are drugs that can save lives and are marked out for time-sensitive usage. Also being examined are possible inter-State links, as investigators have launched a complete review of the supply chain. The illicit channels through which private hospitals bought and used these drugs, including possible complicity in the private hospital network, are under scrutiny.

With alarming regularity, issues to do with poor quality, spurious, fake or expired drugs hit the headlines in India. For a nation that zealously aspires to become the 'pharmacy of the world', India struggles to match its ambition with adequate and stringent monitoring and quality control systems. The question of drug quality is particularly significant as fake or spurious drugs can cause immediate adverse reactions, lead to severe disabilities, and even death. Recent incidents of contaminated cough syrups causing deaths, not only in India, but across the world, have further highlighted these woefully inadequate systems and consistently dented the pride of the "Make in India" campaign. Irrespective of whether India becomes the pharmacy of the world, there is a pressing need to make sure that drugs and medical supplies made in the country fulfil the highest quality standards.

Regulatory surveillance is still too reactive

Quality control must extend beyond the manufacturer

Hospital procurement is an additional vulnerability

pharmacovigilance reporting

Fragmented enforcement creates gaps

A weak domestic system creates an asymmetric credibility problem

It can increase regulatory barriers for Indian exports

It threatens India's soft power in healthcare

The solution is a shift from inspection to traceability

SC shifting from anthropocentric to ecocentric approach: Justice Nagarathna

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 20

DESCRIBING THE contribution of the Supreme Court to environmental jurisprudence as “overwhelming and significant”, Justice B V Nagarathna on Sunday said the apex court is now pushing for a shift from an anthropocentric to an ecocentric approach on this aspect.

“Environmental adjudication is an exercise in foresight, requiring courts to govern the present with an alert consciousness of the future,” Justice B V Nagarathna said while addressing the valedictory session of an international conference on “The Future of Environment and Climate Dynamics” organised by the NGT. President Droupadi Murmu was the chief guest.

Environmental law must move away from treating nature as property, commodity or resource, Justice Nagarathna said.

“The contribution of the Supreme Court to environmental jurisprudence has been overwhelming and significant. In fact, the Supreme Court is now pushing for a shift from an anthropocentric approach to an ecocentric approach in matters of environment,” Justice Nagarathna said.

An anthropocentric approach regards human beings as the central or most vital element in the universe, while an ecocentric approach places the natural environment and ecosystems at the centre of moral consideration, rather than just human beings.

She said this entails recognising that human interests do not, by virtue of being human, enjoy automatic precedence over the interests of the non-human world. Rather, humans bear obligations towards non-human life that exist independently of their utility to them.

“In recent years, courts across many jurisdictions, including the SC, have emerged as central actors in giving concrete meaning to the idea of environmental justice. This aligns environmental protection with substantive equality, insisting that environmental governance must account not only for aggregated outcomes but for their differentiated social impacts.”

NGT Chairperson Justice Prakash Shrivastava said environmental protection must go beyond identifying challenges and focus on building laws, institutions and partnerships capable of responding to emerging environmental threats. “Those with fewer resources often face the greatest risk. Climate action must therefore be inclusive, equitable, and attentive to vulnerable communities and future generations,” he said.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said environmental challenges can no longer be addressed by a single institution or discipline and require the combined efforts of law, governance, science, economics and society.

Manohar Lal, Union Minister of Housing and Urban Affairs and Minister of Power, also spoke at the event.

Environmental justice ; “Protect vulnerable humans from unequal environmental harm.”

Intergenerational equity ; “Protect people who will exist in the future.”

Ecocentrism ; “Recognise ecological systems and non-human life as having value beyond their usefulness to humans.”

Article 21 ; right to a healthy environment

Article 48A ; State's duty to protect and improve the environment

Article 51A(g) ; fundamental duty of citizens to protect the natural environment

Polluter Pays Principle “development vs environment”

**Tropical cyclones are
largely confined to
South China sea, Bay of
Bengal and Gulf of
Mexico. Why?**

Thank you

“The price of success is daily effort”



gallantias@gmail.com



+91 9746035110